

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	SFT5053
Subject Title	Capstone Project – Innovative Business Proposal
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	SFT5051 International Study Tours and Workshops (Europe/North America) and SFT5052 International Study Tours and Workshops (Asia)
Objectives	The goals of this course will enable students to 1. Identify and critically examine a focused topic of global business challenges and opportunities in fashion industry; 2. Integrate previous knowledge among various seminars as well as between learning and their working experiences in developing new business ideas; 3. Attain an integrated understanding of global fashion management by critically evaluating relevant information into a novel interpretation; and 4. Demonstrate their ability in developing and presenting their business ideas, arguments, and outcomes related to real world situations.
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) Identify and apply appropriate knowledge and techniques to address a global fashion business challenge in sectors such as retail and marketing, production, supply chain management, consumer behavior, sustainability, branding and communications; b) Design and implement a major piece of research and demonstrate an awareness of, or sensitivity to, socio-cultural and environmental requirements in the fashion industry; c) Formulate creative solutions to global fashion industry problems that draws on critical thinking, knowledge, and creative problem-solving skills; and

	d) Present the business ideas in a professional and logical manner which embrace new developments and new ways of thinking.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	Students are arranged into small groups on a project topic relating to global challenges and business opportunities in the fashion industry. There is no set syllabus for the business proposal. Students may select their own study areas in sectors such as retail and marketing, production, supply chain management, consumer behavior, sustainability, branding and communications. The students have to identify the business problems or opportunities, and define the scope of research. Upon the agreement with the project supervisor, students are expected to produce a substantial body of literature review and conduct primary research of their chosen topic, which forms the basis of the business solutions. The outcome of the project should demonstrate creative and innovative thinking in the face of global business opportunities or challenges. The work should also build on the knowledge and skills developed in the previous stages of idea generation as well as research and analysis. Students will have to consider and justify the feasibility and originality of their business solutions for fashion businesses and professionals to apply and adapt in a real-world work situation.
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	Lectures and seminars are provided at the initial stage to help students identify valid topics, formulate a research approach, prepare literature review, and develop appropriate methods and analytical skills. Thereafter, students are arranged into small groups to identify a global business challenge or opportunity in the fashion industry in sectors such as retail and marketing, production, supply chain management, consumer behavior, sustainability, branding and communications. The subject lecturer will serve as a project supervisor for the group project. The project supervisor is responsible for negotiating and agreeing with the students on the topic, and provides guidance on the project management. The students have to work closely with their supervisor. They have to report their research process and the preparation of a creative business plan. Continued interactions between the student groups and supervisor are important to ensure satisfactory progress of the project. It is important, however, that the students take responsibility for their project and should not become dependent on the supervisor.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)			
			a	b	c	d
	1. Business Plan	60%	✓	✓	✓	✓
	2. Oral Presentation	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Total	100 %				
	An assessment panel comprising academic faculty and industry professionals will jointly allocate a grade. The business proposal and oral presentation should demonstrate the students’ professional knowledge in addressing the identified issues of their selected topic about global fashion business challenges and opportunities. The panel has the responsibility whether the business plan and the oral presentation reaches the necessary level of a Master’s degree.					
	The business plan and oral presentation must satisfy the Assessment Panel in the following:					
	• Adequate knowledge of the chosen research topic; • Understanding of the issues with some original use of theories of applications of research; • Mastery of primary research methods and analytical procedures where appropriate to the problem identified; • Critical evaluation of current opinion, statements, and commercial approaches providing evidences of the synthesis of theory and practices; • Deliver a creative and innovative solution and demonstrate the ability to critically evaluate the results of decision made; • Express relevant original ideas presenting the arguments coherently and logically.					
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:					
	▪ Lectures and seminars					12 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:					
	▪ Assignment					72 Hrs.
	▪ Reading					36 Hrs.
	Total student study effort					120 Hrs.

Reading List and References	Hair, J. F. Jr., Page, M., and Brunsveld, N. (2020). <i>Essentials of Business Research Methods</i>. New York: Routledge. Easterby-Smith, M., (2018). <i>Management & Business Research</i>. Los Angeles, California: SAGE. Usunier, J., van Herk, H., and Lee, J. A. (2017). <i>International and Cross-cultural Business Research</i>. London: SAGE Publications Ltd. Eriksson, P. and Kovalainen, A. (2016). <i>Qualitative Methods in Business Research</i>. London: SAGE Publications Ltd. Vecchi, Alessandra and Chitra Buckley (2016). <i>Handbook of Research on Global Fashion Management and Merchandising</i>, Hershey, PA: Business Science Reference.
------------------------------------	---

Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

(Form AR 140) 8.2020